Chapter 47 — Doze, App Standby & Background Execution Limits

> **Part VI — Lifecycle, Background & Platform** · Complexity: **Complex** (≥40 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 30 (WorkManager), Ch 46 (foreground services), Ch 44 (lifecycle), Ch 48 (alarms), Ch 49 (FCM). Foundational for every background feature (sync Ch 29/32, outbox Ch 31, uploads Ch 17).
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** making background sync, uploads, and notifications reliable *and* battery-friendly across Doze, App Standby Buckets, and OEM battery managers — so work completes without draining the battery or getting the app killed.

47.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

Android's single biggest source of user complaints historically was **battery drain from apps working in the background**. Over many releases Google built an escalating set of **background execution restrictions** — **Doze**, **App Standby Buckets**, **background service limits**, **background location limits**, **battery optimization**, and (on top of AOSP) aggressive **OEM battery managers** (Xiaomi, Huawei, Samsung, OnePlus, etc.). The result: **you cannot assume your background code runs when you want it to.** Alarms are deferred, network is blocked, services are killed, and jobs are delayed — sometimes for hours — unless you cooperate with the system.

This is the central reliability tension of Android background work:

- **Deferred/blocked work.** In Doze, the device batches background activity into periodic **maintenance windows**; outside them, network access and wakelocks are suspended and **alarms/jobs are deferred**. A naive `AlarmManager` alarm or raw thread simply won't fire/run on time.
- **App Standby Buckets.** The OS classifies each app into **active / working-set / frequent / rare / restricted** based on usage, and throttles its jobs, alarms, FCM quota, and network accordingly. A rarely-used app's background work is heavily limited.
- **Background service limits (Android 8+).** You can't freely start background services; `startService` from the background throws unless it becomes a foreground service (Ch 46) — pushing most background work to **WorkManager/JobScheduler**.
- **OEM killers.** Many OEMs kill or "optimize" backgrounded apps far more aggressively than AOSP, breaking even correct WorkManager usage unless the user exempts the app.
- **Doing it wrong both ways.** Fighting the system (wakelocks, exact alarms, foreground-service abuse) drains battery and gets you flagged/killed; ignoring it means work never completes. The craft is **cooperating** with the restrictions.

The architecture: **understand each restriction** (Doze, Buckets, service/location limits, battery optimization, OEM behavior); **use the OS-blessed mechanisms** — **WorkManager** for deferrable work (it respects and schedules around all of this), **foreground services** (Ch 46) for ongoing user-visible work, **exact alarms** (Ch 48) only for genuine user-facing time precision, **high-priority FCM** (Ch 49) for time-sensitive wake-ups; **set correct**

constraints (network, charging, idle) so work runs in the right window; **request exemptions sparingly and legitimately** (battery- optimization/exact-alarm exemptions) with clear justification; and **degrade gracefully** when work is throttled. This chapter is about **reliable background work that respects battery** — the hardest, most device-fragmented area of Android.

Three practical use cases

1. **StreamCart periodic sync.** A periodic WorkManager job with network constraints that runs in Doze maintenance windows / per the app's bucket, batching efficiently (Ch 29/32) — not an exact alarm.
2. **Time-sensitive notification.** A price-drop/order-update that must wake the app promptly → **high-priority FCM** (Ch 49), which is allowed limited Doze wake-ups, rather than a background poll.
3. **OEM-killed sync.** Detecting an aggressive OEM, guiding the user to disable battery optimization for the app, and using a foreground service for the critical path.

Why this is architectural

Background execution limits are a **platform contract that shapes every background feature**: which mechanism to use, what constraints to set, how to handle deferral and device fragmentation, and when (and how legitimately) to seek exemptions. Getting it wrong fails sync reliability *or* battery life — both are user-visible and ranked by the Play Store.

47.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	Deferrable background work completes reliably (eventually), respecting battery.
F2	Time-sensitive work wakes the app promptly via allowed mechanisms.
F3	Set correct constraints so work runs in the right conditions (network/charging/idle).
F4	Detect and handle restriction (bucket demotion, battery optimization, OEM killing).
F5	Request exemptions only when legitimate, with user consent.
F6	Degrade gracefully under throttling (backoff, catch-up on next window).

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Target/Policy
Battery	Cooperate with Doze/Buckets; no wakelock/exact-alarm abuse.
Reliability	Work completes within acceptable latency per its urgency.
Compatibility	Works across OS versions + major OEMs.
Compliance	Exemptions justified (Play scrutinizes); correct mechanism per use.
Observability	Measure completion latency, deferral, kills by device/bucket.

Scope

- **In scope:** Doze (deep + light), App Standby Buckets, background service/location limits, battery optimization/allowlist, OEM battery managers, choosing mechanisms (WorkManager/FGS/exact alarm/high-priority FCM), constraints, exemptions (`REQUEST_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATIONS`, exact-alarm permission), graceful degradation, measurement.
- **Out of scope:** WorkManager internals (Ch 30), FGS detail (Ch 46), alarms detail (Ch 48), FCM detail (Ch 49), sync algorithms (Ch 32).

Assumptions & constraints

- `minSdk 24` (Doze since 23, Buckets since 28, service limits since 26). WorkManager as the primary scheduler. Device fragmentation is a hard reality; OEM behavior is not fully controllable — design for it, don't assume AOSP.

47.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **Doze (device idle):** when the device is unplugged, screen-off, and stationary for a while, it enters **deep Doze**: periodic **maintenance windows** (increasingly far apart) are the only times background apps run; outside them network access and wakelocks are suspended, standard alarms and jobs are **deferred** to the next window, and `AlarmManager` is batched. **Light Doze** (screen-off but moving / recently used) is a lighter version with more frequent windows. **What survives Doze:** high-priority FCM (limited), foreground services, exact alarms (`setExactAndAllowWhileIdle` / `setAlarmClock`, Ch 48), and WorkManager jobs (run in windows).

- **App Standby Buckets (Android 9+):** the OS buckets each app by usage — **active** (in use / just used), **working set** (regular use), **frequent**, **rare**, **restricted** (rarely used or misbehaving) — and throttles **jobs, alarms, FCM quota, and network** progressively per bucket. The worse the bucket, the more your background work is delayed and the smaller your high-priority-FCM budget. Keeping the app useful (so users open it) keeps it in a good bucket; the **restricted** bucket is near-total background suspension.

- **Background service limits (Android 8+):** apps can't start background services at will; `startService` from background throws `BackgroundServiceStartNotAllowed`. The OS pushes you to **WorkManager/JobScheduler** for deferrable work and **foreground services** (Ch 46) for ongoing visible work.

- **Battery optimization / allowlist:** by default apps are "optimized" (subject to Doze/ Standby). An app can be **allowlisted** (exempt from some Doze restrictions) — either by the user via settings or by prompting with `ACTION_REQUEST_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATIONS`. **Use this sparingly and legitimately** — Play restricts which app categories may request it, and abuse causes rejection.
- **OEM battery managers (the fragmentation reality):** many OEMs add **aggressive** background killing on top of AOSP (killing WorkManager jobs, ignoring standard guarantees) unless the user manually exempts the app (varies per OEM; see dontkillmyapp.com-style guidance). You **cannot** fully control this in code — detect likely-aggressive OEMs and **guide the user** to the right settings; use a foreground service for truly critical paths.
- **Mechanism selection (the decision):**

Need	Mechanism	Why
Deferrable background work (sync, upload)	**WorkManager** (Ch 30)	Respects Doze/Buckets; reschedules; constraints
Ongoing user-visible work (playback, active download)	**Foreground service** (Ch 46)	Exempt while running
Prompt wake for time-sensitive data	**High-priority FCM** (Ch 49)	Allowed limited Doze wake-ups
Genuine user-facing exact time (alarm clock, calendar)	**Exact alarm** (Ch 48)	`setAlarmClock` / `setExactAndAllowWhileIdle`
Precise periodic polling	❌ (don't)	Fights the system; use FCM/WorkManager

- **Constraints (make work run in the right window):** WorkManager constraints (`NetworkType`, `requiresCharging`, `requiresDeviceIdle`, `requiresBatteryNotLow`) tell the OS *when* to run — e.g., heavy sync only on **unmetered + charging** runs during Doze maintenance windows at low cost. Correct constraints = reliable *and* battery-friendly.
- **Graceful degradation:** assume work may be **deferred**; design for **catch-up** (delta/incremental sync on next window, Ch 32), **backoff** (Ch 2/30), and **idempotency** (Ch 15) so deferral/retry is safe. Don't assume exact timing.

Core insight: **you cannot run arbitrary background code on your own schedule — Doze, App Standby Buckets, service limits, battery optimization, and OEM killers all throttle it. Cooperate: use WorkManager for deferrable work (with correct constraints so it runs in the right Doze window), foreground services for ongoing visible work, high-priority FCM for prompt wake-ups, and exact alarms only for genuine user-facing time; request battery-optimization/OEM exemptions only when legitimate and user-consented; and design work to be deferrable, idempotent, and catch-up-capable so throttling degrades it gracefully instead of breaking it.**

47.4 High-Level Architecture


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Components & ownership

- **Classifier/decision** maps each need to the OS-blessed mechanism.
- **WorkManager** carries deferrable work with constraints; the **OS** governs when (Doze/bucket).
- **OEM handling** detects aggressive devices and guides the user; FGS for critical paths.
- **Degradation** (catch-up/backoff/idempotency) makes deferral safe.

Direction: classify → OS-blessed mechanism + constraints → OS schedules in window → handle OEM/exemptions → degrade gracefully.

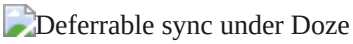
47.5 Detailed Component Design


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Component	Responsibility
`BackgroundWorkRouter`	pick mechanism per need (WM/FGS/FCM/alarm)
`StandbyBucketMonitor`	read `UsageStatsManager.appStandbyBucket` → adapt expectations
`BatteryOptimizationHelper`	check/request allowlist (legitimate cases only)
`OemBatteryHelper`	detect aggressive OEMs; guide user

47.6 End-to-End Data Flow

Deferrable sync under Doze


Deferrable sync under Doze

Time-sensitive wake via high-priority FCM


Time-sensitive wake via high-priority FCM

47.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.background`.

47.7.1 Deferrable periodic sync with correct constraints (not an alarm)

```
@Singleton
class SyncScheduler @Inject constructor(private val workManager: WorkManager) {
    fun schedulePeriodicSync() {
        val constraints = Constraints.Builder()
            .setRequiredNetworkType(NetworkType.UNMETERED)   // run on wifi
            .setRequiresBatteryNotLow(true)
            .build()                                          // OS runs it in a Doze window
when met
        val request = PeriodicWorkRequestBuilder<SyncWorker>(6, TimeUnit.HOURS)
            .setConstraints(constraints)
            .setBackoffCriteria(BackoffPolicy.EXPONENTIAL, 30, TimeUnit.SECONDS)  // graceful
retry (Ch 2)
            .build()
        workManager.enqueueUniquePeriodicWork("sync", ExistingPeriodicWorkPolicy.KEEP, request)
    }
    // Time-sensitive one-off that should run ASAP within OS allowance:
    fun expedite() = workManager.enqueue(
        OneTimeWorkRequestBuilder<SyncWorker>()
            .setExpedited(OutOfQuotaPolicy.RUN_AS_NON_EXPEDITED_WORK_REQUEST)  // expedited
where allowed
            .build())
}
```

47.7.2 Standby bucket awareness (adapt expectations, log)

```
@Singleton
class StandbyBucketMonitor @Inject constructor(@ApplicationContext private val ctx: Context) {
    private val usageStats = ctx.getSystemService(Context.USAGE_STATS_SERVICE) as
UsageStatsManager
    fun currentBucket(): Int = usageStats.appStandbyBucket   //
ACTIVE/WORKING_SET/FREQUENT/RARE/RESTRICTED
    fun isRestricted(): Boolean =
        currentBucket() >= UsageStatsManager.STANDBY_BUCKET_RESTRICTED
    // Use to: log/measure, widen sync intervals in bad buckets, and warn if RESTRICTED.
}
```

47.7.3 Battery-optimization exemption (legitimate cases only, user-consented)

```
@Singleton
class BatteryOptimizationHelper @Inject constructor(@ApplicationContext private val ctx:
Context) {
    private val pm = ctx.getSystemService(Context.POWER_SERVICE) as PowerManager
    fun isIgnoringOptimizations(): Boolean = pm.isIgnoringBatteryOptimizations(ctx.packageName)

    /** Only for app categories Play allows (e.g., alarm/health). Show rationale FIRST (Ch 51
pattern). */
    @SuppressLint("BatteryLife")
    fun exemptionIntent(): Intent = Intent(Settings.ACTION_REQUEST_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATIONS)
        .setData(Uri.parse("package:${ctx.packageName}"))
    // Prefer linking to Settings.ACTION_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATION_SETTINGS for general apps.
}
```

47.7.4 OEM detection + guidance (can't fix in code; guide the user)

```
object OemBatteryHelper {
    private val aggressive = setOf("xiaomi", "huawei", "honor", "oppo", "vivo", "oneplus",
"samsung", "meizu")
    fun isAggressiveOem(): Boolean = Build.MANUFACTURER.lowercase() in aggressive

    /** Best-effort deep link to the OEM's auto-start/battery settings; fall back to app
settings. */
    fun oemSettingsIntents(): List<Intent> = listOf(
        Intent().setComponent(ComponentName("com.miui.securitycenter",
            "com.miui.permcenter.autostart.AutoStartManagementActivity")),
        // ... other OEM components (wrapped in try/catch when launching) ...
        Intent(Settings.ACTION_APPLICATION_DETAILS_SETTINGS, Uri.parse("package:$PKG")),  //
fallback
    )
}
```

47.7.5 Graceful degradation: idempotent catch-up sync

```
// SyncWorker is idempotent (Ch 15) and does delta/catch-up sync (Ch 32), so deferral/retry is
safe.
@HiltWorker
class SyncWorker @AssistedInject constructor(
    @Assisted ctx: Context, @Assisted p: WorkerParameters, private val repo: SyncRepository,
) : CoroutineWorker(ctx, p) {
    override suspend fun doWork(): Result = runCatching {
        repo.deltaSyncSince(repo.lastSyncCursor())   // catch up whatever was missed while
deferred
    }.fold({ Result.success() }, { if (runAttemptCount < 5) Result.retry() else Result.failure()
})
}
```

47.7.6 Module structure

```
:core:background  SyncScheduler, StandbyBucketMonitor, BatteryOptimizationHelper,
OemBatteryHelper, BackgroundWorkRouter
:core:work        SyncWorker (idempotent, delta/catch-up) [Ch 30/32]
# FGS -> :core:fgs (Ch 46); FCM -> :feature:push (Ch 49); alarms -> :core:alarm (Ch 48).
```

47.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Work deferred to a later window	stale data	idempotent delta/catch-up sync (Ch 32/15)
Retry after throttle	duplicates	idempotency keys (Ch 15)
Multiple windows run overlapping work	races	`enqueueUniqueWork`/single-flight (Ch 11/30)
Bucket demotion mid-session	unexpected delay	adapt intervals; measure bucket
FCM quota exhausted	push dropped/delayed	don't over-send high-priority; fall back to WorkManager
Exact alarm fires in Doze	battery/abuse flag	use only for genuine user-facing time (Ch 48)

- **Design for deferral, not timing.** Because the OS decides *when* work runs, two "scheduled" runs can collapse into one window or be far apart — make work **idempotent** (Ch 15) and **catch-up-based** (sync since a cursor, Ch 32) so order/timing don't matter.
- **Unique work** prevents overlapping jobs when windows and triggers coincide (`enqueueUniquePeriodicWork` / `enqueueUniqueWork`, Ch 30).

47.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
Sync never runs (OEM kill)	completion telemetry by OEM	guide user to exempt; FGS for critical path	runs
Work delayed hours (RESTRICTED bucket)	bucket telemetry	encourage engagement; widen intervals; high-priority FCM for urgent	acceptable
Exact alarm abuse → flagged	Play/battery stats	switch to WorkManager/FCM	compliant
High-priority FCM dropped	delivery telemetry (Ch 49)	reduce volume; expedited WorkManager fallback	delivered within quota
Battery drain complaint	Android vitals (wakelocks)	remove wakelock/exact-alarm abuse; constraints	battery ok
Background start crash	crash	WorkManager/FGS, not `startService`	compliant
Stale data after long idle	user report	catch-up delta sync on next window	fresh



> **The system is not broken when it defers your work — it is working as designed.** Reliability comes from choosing the OS-blessed mechanism, setting constraints, and making work idempotent/catch-up — not from fighting Doze. Fighting it (wakelocks, exact alarms, FGS abuse) gets you battery-flagged *and* OEM-killed.

47.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** All deferrable work on WorkManager with sensible constraints; FGS for ongoing visible work (Ch 46).
- **Level 2.** High-priority FCM for time-sensitive wake-ups (Ch 49); expedited work where allowed; idempotent catch-up sync (Ch 32/15).
- **Level 3 — production.** Standby-bucket awareness; battery-optimization exemption for legitimate categories (consented); OEM detection + user guidance; completion telemetry by bucket/OEM/OS.
- **Level 4 — large.** Per-feature background budgets; adaptive sync intervals by bucket/ battery; FCM-quota-aware prioritization (Ch 14); FGS reserved for truly critical paths; Android-vitals battery monitoring.
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** Background-work governance (which mechanisms teams may use), device-fragmentation dashboards (completion by OEM/OS/bucket), automated battery- regression gates, documented degradation SLOs per feature urgency tier.

Avoid overengineering: for most apps, **WorkManager with correct constraints + high-priority FCM for urgent + idempotent catch-up sync** is the whole story. Don't add exemption prompts, OEM deep-links, or bucket logic unless telemetry shows you need them — each adds friction and Play risk.

47.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Deferrable work	WorkManager	exact alarm + raw service	WorkManager always (respects limits); alarms fight the system
Prompt wake	High-priority FCM	background polling	FCM (allowed Doze wake); polling is blocked/battery-flagged
Ongoing visible	Foreground service	wakelock + background service	FGS (Ch 46); wakelock abuse is killed/flagged
Reliability on OEMs	User-guided exemption + FGS critical path	assume AOSP guarantees	Guide/FGS; AOSP assumption breaks on OEMs
Exemption	Request only for legitimate categories	request for everyone	Legitimate-only (Play rejects abuse)
Degradation	Idempotent catch-up + backoff	assume exact timing	Catch-up (deferral-safe); exact-timing breaks

WorkManager vs exact alarms for periodic work: exact alarms (`setExactAndAllowWhileIdle`) *can* fire in Doze, which tempts developers to use them for "reliable" periodic sync — but this fights the battery model, is heavily rate-limited, flags your app for battery drain, and on Android 12+ requires the `SCHEDULE_EXACT_ALARM` / `USE_EXACT_ALARM` permission reserved for genuine user-facing timing (alarm clocks, calendars, Ch 48). WorkManager with constraints is the correct tool for deferrable periodic work: it runs in maintenance windows at low battery cost and reschedules automatically.

High-priority FCM vs background polling: to react to a server event promptly, polling from the background is blocked/deferred by Doze and burns battery for nothing most of the time. High-priority FCM is the OS-blessed way to wake the app for time-sensitive data (limited Doze wake-ups, bucket-dependent quota). Use FCM to *push* the trigger, then do the work with WorkManager/expedited work (Ch 49).

Battery-optimization exemption vs cooperating: an exemption makes your background work more reliable but costs battery, annoys users, and is Play-restricted to certain app categories. Most apps should **cooperate** (WorkManager + FCM) rather than request exemptions; reserve exemptions for apps whose core function genuinely requires it (alarms, health monitoring, sync-heavy enterprise), always with a clear rationale and user consent.

47.12 Security & Privacy Considerations

- **Background location is doubly restricted** (Doze + background-location permission, Ch 67): only access it during an active, user-understood foreground session or FGS — never silently in the background.
- **Exemption prompts are a social-engineering surface:** be honest about *why* you need the exemption; don't trick users into allowlisting for battery-draining purposes (Play policy + user trust).
- **High-priority FCM payloads** reach the app in Doze — treat them as untrusted (Ch 49), validate, and don't include sensitive data in the push itself (Ch 28).
- **OEM deep-links** must fall back gracefully and never assume a component exists (wrap in try/catch) — a crash here is a trust/UX hit.
- **Don't abuse `systemExempted` / `specialUse` FGS types** (Ch 46) to dodge limits — Play scrutinizes this.

- Client vs backend: the backend should **send time-sensitive events as pushes** rather than expecting the client to poll, and should tolerate **catch-up sync** patterns (delta since cursor, Ch 32) since client timing is non-deterministic.

47.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **Correct constraints are the main battery lever:** heavy work on **unmetered + charging + battery-not-low** runs in Doze windows essentially for free.
- **Batch background work** (one periodic sync, not many timers) so the OS coalesces it into fewer windows (Ch 14).
- **Don't hold wakelocks**; let WorkManager manage execution. Wakelocks are a top battery offender and OEM-kill trigger.
- **Adapt to bucket/battery:** widen sync intervals in worse buckets / low battery; skip non-essential work.
- **Minimize high-priority FCM** (quota- and battery-costly); use normal-priority for non-urgent, and coalesce server events.
- **Profiling:** Battery Historian (Doze state, wakelocks, alarms, jobs), Android vitals (excessive wakeups/wakelocks), completion-latency telemetry by bucket/OEM.

47.14 Testing Strategy

Background limits are tested with `adb` **Doze/Standby simulation**, WorkManager test APIs, and **device-matrix** (OEM) testing.

```
# Simulate deep Doze (force the device idle) and verify work defers/catches up:
adb shell dumpsys deviceidle force-idle
adb shell dumpsys deviceidle unforce
# Set a standby bucket to verify throttled behavior:
adb shell am set-standby-bucket com.streamcart restricted
# Inspect scheduled jobs/alarms:
adb shell dumpsys jobscheduler | grep streamcart
adb shell dumpsys alarm | grep streamcart
```

```
// WorkManager constraints + catch-up (Ch 30 TestDriver):
@Test fun `periodic sync runs when constraints met and catches up`() = runTest {
    val wm = WorkManagerTestInitHelper.getTestDriver(context)!!
    // enqueue; setAllConstraintsMet(id); setPeriodDelayMet(id); assert delta/catch-up sync ran
}
@Test fun `sync worker is idempotent under retry`() = runTest { /* run twice, assert no
duplicates (Ch 15) */ }
```

What to test: Doze deferral + catch-up (adb force-idle), restricted-bucket behavior (set-standby-bucket), constraint gating (WM TestDriver), idempotent retry, FCM→expedited path (Ch 49), exemption-state read, OEM deep-link

fallback (no crash). Device-matrix testing on major OEMs is essential — emulator behavior under-represents OEM killing.

47.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics:** background-work **completion latency** and success rate **by standby bucket / OEM / OS version**; deferral counts; WorkManager job attempts/failures; FGS kill counts (Ch 46); high-priority FCM delivery + quota (Ch 49); Android vitals excessive-wakeup/wakelock rates; battery-optimization-exemption acceptance.
- **Logs:** `bg_work{mechanism, bucket, oem, os, latency, result}` (no PII, Ch 28).
- **Debugging:** sync unreliable on one OEM → OEM killing (guide user / FGS); work always delayed → RESTRICTED bucket (engagement) or wrong mechanism; battery flagged → wakelock/ exact-alarm abuse; FCM delayed → quota exhausted (reduce volume).
- **Alerting:** completion-rate drop on a specific OEM/OS after an update; battery-vitals regression.
- **Dashboards:** completion by OEM × OS × bucket (the fragmentation matrix) — the key artifact for this domain.

47.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥40 questions.

Doze

1. *What is Doze?* Device-idle mode batching background activity into maintenance windows; network/wakelocks suspended, alarms/jobs deferred outside them.
2. *Deep vs light Doze?* Stationary+unplugged+screen-off (windows far apart) vs screen-off/recently-used (more frequent).
3. *What survives Doze?* High-priority FCM (limited), FGS, exact alarms (`setExactAndAllowWhileIdle` / `setAlarmClock`), WorkManager jobs (in windows).
4. *Maintenance window?* Periodic interval when deferred background work runs.
5. *Why Doze exists?* Battery life; top historical complaint.

App Standby Buckets

6. *What are buckets?* Active/working-set/frequent/rare/restricted usage tiers that throttle jobs/alarms/FCM/network.
7. *How assigned?* By usage/recency (and misbehavior → restricted).
8. *Restricted bucket?* Near-total background suspension.
9. *How to stay in a good bucket?* Keep the app useful so users open it.
10. *Read the bucket?* `UsageStatsManager.appStandbyBucket`.

Service/background limits

11. *Android 8 background service limit?* Can't start background services freely; `startService` from background throws.

12. *What replaced free background services?* WorkManager/JobScheduler + FGS.
13. *Background location limits?* Throttled; needs background-location permission (Ch 67).

Battery optimization / OEM

14. *Battery optimization?* Default state subjecting apps to Doze/Standby; allowlist exempts.
15. *How request exemption?* `ACTION_REQUEST_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATIONS` (legitimate categories only).
16. *Risk of exemption?* Battery cost, user annoyance, Play restriction.
17. *OEM battery managers?* Aggressive killing beyond AOSP; need user to exempt; not code-fixable.
18. *Handling OEMs?* Detect + guide user; FGS for critical path.

Mechanism selection

19. *Deferrable work?* WorkManager.
20. *Ongoing visible?* Foreground service (Ch 46).
21. *Prompt time-sensitive wake?* High-priority FCM (Ch 49).
22. *Genuine user-facing exact time?* Exact alarm (Ch 48).
23. *Why not exact alarms for sync?* Fights battery model; rate-limited; permission- restricted; flagged.
24. *Why not background polling?* Blocked/deferred/battery-flagged — use FCM.

Constraints & degradation

25. *WorkManager constraints?* Network/charging/idle/battery — run in the right window.
26. *Heavy sync constraint?* Unmetered + charging → runs in Doze windows cheaply.
27. *Expedited work?* `setExpedited` for time-sensitive one-offs within quota.
28. *Graceful degradation?* Idempotent catch-up delta sync + backoff.
29. *Why idempotent?* Deferral/retry can duplicate (Ch 15).
30. *Catch-up sync?* Sync since a cursor (Ch 32) regardless of timing.

Security/privacy

31. *Background location?* Only during active/foreground/FGS session; permission-gated.
32. *Exemption honesty?* Don't trick users; Play policy + trust.
33. *FCM payload in Doze?* Untrusted; no sensitive data in push.
34. *OEM deep-link safety?* try/catch + fallback (component may not exist).

Testing

35. *Simulate Doze?* `adb dumpsys deviceidle force-idle`.
36. *Set a bucket?* `adb am set-standby-bucket ... restricted`.
37. *Why device-matrix?* OEM killing varies; emulator under-represents.
38. *Test constraints?* WorkManager `TestDriver`.

Production

39. *Sync unreliable on one OEM?* OEM killing — guide user / FGS.
40. *Always-delayed work?* Restricted bucket or wrong mechanism.
41. *Battery flagged in vitals?* Wakelock/exact-alarm abuse — cooperate.
42. *FCM delayed?* Quota exhausted — reduce volume; expedited fallback.
43. *Key dashboard?* Completion by OEM × OS × bucket.

Design-change challenges

1. **Sync works on Pixel but not Xiaomi.** OEM killing — detect + guide to disable battery optimization; FGS for critical path.
2. **React to a server event within seconds while backgrounded.** High-priority FCM → expedited WorkManager (not polling).
3. **Battery team flags the app for wakeups.** Remove wakelocks/exact alarms; move to WorkManager + constraints.
4. **Periodic sync is deferred for hours.** Expected under Doze/restricted bucket — idempotent catch-up; FCM for urgent; improve engagement.
5. **An "alarm" feature needs exact timing.** Exact alarm with proper permission (Ch 48) — the legitimate exemption case.

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (urgency, frequency, user-visible?, target OEMs/OS?) → explain Doze/Buckets/ limits → classify mechanism (WorkManager/FGS/FCM/alarm) → set constraints → design for deferral (idempotent catch-up + backoff) → OEM/exemption handling (legitimate only) → measure completion by OEM/bucket → security (background location, exemption honesty).

47.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Convert a periodic sync from an `AlarmManager` alarm to a WorkManager periodic job with `unmetered` + `batteryNotLow` constraints. *Eval:* runs in Doze windows; no battery flag.
2. **Intermediate.** Add high-priority FCM → expedited WorkManager for a time-sensitive update; verify it wakes under `adb` force-idle. *Eval:* wakes promptly; no polling.
3. **Advanced.** Make sync idempotent + catch-up (delta since cursor) so deferral/retry is safe; test under forced Doze and `restricted` bucket. *Eval:* no duplicates; catches up.
4. **Production debugging.** Diagnose OEM-killed sync: detect aggressive OEM, guide the user to exempt, use an FGS for the critical path. *Eval:* reliable on the OEM; graceful fallback.
5. **System design challenge.** Build a completion-by-OEM×OS×bucket dashboard and a policy for when (and how legitimately) to request battery-optimization exemptions. *Eval:* fragmentation visible; exemption policy sound.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

47.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: accept that **you cannot run arbitrary background code on your own schedule** — Doze (maintenance windows), App Standby Buckets, background service/location limits, battery optimization, and aggressive OEM managers all throttle it — and **cooperate** instead of fighting: use **WorkManager** for deferrable work with **correct constraints** (network/charging/idle) so it runs in Doze windows cheaply, **foreground services** (Ch 46) for ongoing user-visible work, **high-priority FCM** (Ch 49) for prompt time-sensitive wake-ups (then expedited WorkManager), and **exact alarms** (Ch 48) **only** for genuine user-facing time; design work to be

idempotent and catch-up-based (delta since cursor, Ch 32/15) so deferral/retry degrades gracefully; **detect aggressive OEMs and guide users** to exempt the app (and use an FGS for truly critical paths); and **request battery-optimization exemptions only for legitimate app categories, with consent**. Measure **completion by OEM × OS × bucket** — the fragmentation matrix is the key artifact.

Concepts: Doze (deep/light, maintenance windows), App Standby Buckets, background service/location limits, battery optimization/allowlist, OEM battery managers, mechanism selection (WorkManager/FGS/FCM/alarm), WorkManager constraints, expedited work, graceful degradation (idempotent catch-up), exemptions.

Common mistakes: exact alarms / background polling for periodic sync (battery-flagged, throttled); assuming AOSP guarantees on OEM devices; holding wakelocks; requesting battery exemptions for all apps (Play rejection); assuming exact background timing (not idempotent/ catch-up); no completion telemetry by OEM/bucket; silent background location.

Checklist:

- [ ] deferrable work → WorkManager + constraints
- [ ] ongoing visible → FGS
- [ ] prompt wake → high-priority FCM → expedited work
- [ ] exact time → exact alarm (legit only)
- [ ] idempotent catch-up sync + backoff
- [ ] standby-bucket awareness
- [ ] OEM detection + user guidance
- [ ] exemptions legitimate + consented
- [ ] no wakelock/exact-alarm abuse
- [ ] completion telemetry by OEM × OS × bucket.

Key APIs: WorkManager `Constraints` / `setExpedited` / `enqueueUniquePeriodicWork` (Ch 30), `UsageStatsManager.appStandbyBucket`, `PowerManager.isIgnoringBatteryOptimizations` / `ACTION_REQUEST_IGNORE_BATTERY_OPTIMIZATIONS`, `Build.MANUFACTURER`, `AlarmManager.setExactAndAllowWhileIdle` / `setAlarmClock` (Ch 48), high-priority FCM (Ch 49), `adb dumpsys deviceidle` / `am set-standby-bucket`.

References:

- Doze and App Standby: https://developer.android.com/training/monitoring-device-state/doze-standby
- App Standby Buckets: https://developer.android.com/topic/performance/appstandby
- Background execution limits: https://developer.android.com/about/versions/oreo/background
- Optimize for Doze (testing): https://developer.android.com/training/monitoring-device-state/doze-standby#testing_doze
- (composes) Ch 30 WorkManager, Ch 46 FGS, Ch 48 Alarms, Ch 49 FCM, Ch 32 Delta Sync, Ch 15 Idempotency

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; decision/architecture/class/sequence/failure diagrams; constraints + bucket monitor + exemption + OEM + idempotent catch-up code; concurrency (deferral/idempotency/unique work); failure (OEM/bucket/battery triage); 5 levels; WorkManager-vs-alarm, FCM-vs-polling, exemption-vs-

cooperate trade-offs; security (background location, exemption honesty); perf (constraints/batching); adb-Doze + WM + idempotency tests; observability (OEM×OS×bucket matrix); 43 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅

- **Expand later:** WorkManager (Ch 30), FGS (Ch 46), alarms (Ch 48), FCM (Ch 49), location (Ch 67).
- **Interview coverage:** exceeds ≥40 Complex bar.